

device platform while announcing that a “few friends” would be helping in its development. The few friends were the OHA, a consortium of companies that currently includes names such as Intel, HTC, Asus, Motorola, Vodafone, Sony Ericsson, Nvidia, Texas Instruments and LG, apart from Google. The world was abuzz with the news of ‘The Google Phone’.

And in a move that took everyone by surprise, they announced that the Android would be a completely open-source project. The biggest problem with Linux, the popular open-source operating platform for computers, is that it does not have the backing of any major company to take on the likes of

Microsoft and Apple. Android has not only Microsoft's biggest rivals, but also some of its friends!

Then, in October last year, Sergey Brin and Larry Page rolled out the first device running the OS – literally, as they addressed a press conference while skating around. The T-Mobile G1, built by HTC, has since gone on to be criticised for its shoddy hardware; but Android has been loved by one and all.

It is not known when the device will officially come to Indian shores and how much it will cost, although the grey markets already have ‘Google-wallah phone’ priced between Rs 25,000-30,000. HTC has since announced another



Many hope that the Android OS will mark a turning point for mobile phones